

New Ground: Outside Pressure

新的起点：外部压力

Theme: 大学生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

A **legislative** aide came to the campus in a **purple** coat and asked to see the map. She stared at the wall for a long minute, her **gaze** moving from the gate to the legend. “The **potential** is obvious,” she said, “but this is **controversial**, and the council will not fund a **hazy** promise.” The **sheer enthusiasm** of the volunteers met a cold room. A **funny** detail softened nothing: the lady from the council had arrived with a **cigaret** she was not allowed to light, and she held it like a small, useless tool.

The condition was stated **precisely**: show a working **bypass** for every closed gate, or lose the room. An **enthusiastic** volunteer asked whether a sketch would do; he was told that it would not. “That is **amazing**,” Maya said, meaning the opposite. “It is also impossible.” The **shock** was that the aide agreed. Those five buildings were, normally, the least interesting part of the campus, and yet the whole project now depended on them. The delay began to **weaken** their hold on the room. A **brutal** deadline can **sharpen** a design or **terrify** its makers; this one did both.

They worked in a **muddy** room that began to **darken** at four o'clock. The **mist** outside was thick enough to hide the far gate. A **creamy** soup and a **delicious** bun arrived, and the volunteers ate standing up, usually in silence. “This is **disgusting**,” one girl said, meaning the corridor rather than the food. Small delays began to **annoy** everyone, including the two of them, and a **bloody** scratch on Lin's hand came from fastening the board to the wall.

Among the three hundred notes, a hundred mentioned a lack of light and an equal amount mentioned the cold. A **colorful** diagram fascinated the visitors, and the **fascination** was mutual: the students were in **awe** of the aide's patience, and she was in **awe** of their stamina. Both of them watched her read the whole file. “Do not **deceive** yourselves,” she said at last. “**Urbanization** is not your problem. Access is.” An **awesome** responsibility, Lin thought, for one thin folder.

The **overthrow** of their own first plan necessitated a new method. They fastened the map to a board, sharpened the wording, and built an **adaptive** and **innovative** version that could be edited in an hour. The **potentiality** was real and the excitement was also real, which horrified Professor Zhao slightly. “Yeah,” Lin said, “but a positive attitude does not improve a locked door, and patience alone will not pay for one.” “Instead of defending the room,” he went on, “we should defend the route.” “Yes,” said the aide, “and that is **precisely** why I am still here.”

中文翻译

一位立法助理穿着紫色外套来到校园，要求看看那张地图。她盯着墙面看了很久。“潜力很明显，”她说，“但这件事有争议，委员会不会资助一个模糊的承诺。”志愿者们十足的热情遇上了一间冷冰冰的房间。一个滑稽的细节什么也缓和不了：这位来自委员会的女士带来一支不许点燃的香烟，像握着一件无用的小工具。

条件被精确地说明：为每一道关闭的门拿出可用的绕行方案，否则就失去这间房间。一位热情的志愿者问一张草图行不行；他被告知不行。“太惊人了，”曼雅说，意思是相反的意思，“而且也不可能。”令人震惊的是，这位助理同意她的说法。那五栋楼通常来说是校园里最没意思的部分，而如今整个项目都依赖它们。拖延开始削弱他们对这间房间的掌控。残酷的期限可以让设计变锐利，也可以吓坏它的制作者；这一个两者都做到了。

他们在一间泥泞的屋子里工作，屋子到四点就开始变暗。外面的雾厚得足以遮住远处的大门。一碗奶油汤和一个美味的面包送来了，志愿者们站着吃，通常沉默不语。“这真恶心，”一个女孩说，指的是走廊而不是食物。小小的延误开始让所有人恼火，包括他们两个人；林伟手上那道流血的划痕，是把板子固定到墙上时弄的。

在三百条笔记里，有一百条提到了光线不足，同样数量的笔记提到了寒冷。一张色彩丰富的图表让来访者着迷，而这种着迷是相互的：学生们敬畏这位助理的耐心，她也敬畏他们的耐力。他们两人看着她读完了整份文件。“不要欺骗自己，”她最后说，“城市化不是你们的问题，通行才是。”林伟想，对一份薄薄的文件夹来说，这是一份令人敬畏的责任。

推翻自己第一份计划使新方法成为必需。他们把地图固定在板子上，把措辞磨得更锋利，并做出一个能在一小时内修改的适应型版本。潜在性是真实的，兴奋也是真实的，这让赵教授略微感到恐惧。“是的，”林伟说，“但积极的态度并不能改善一扇锁住的门。”“没错，”助理说，“这正是我还在这里的原因。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
stare steə POS: v	vi. 注视, 凝视, 瞪视, 显眼; vt. 盯; n. 凝视 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fixed look with eyes open wide; v. fixate one's eyes
potential pe'tenʃəl POS: n	n. 潜在性, 可能性, 潜力, 潜能, 势, 位; a. 有潜力的, 可能的, 潜在的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the inherent capacity for coming into being; a. existing in possibility
bloody 'blʌdi POS: a	a. 血腥的, 嗜杀的, 有血的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cover with blood; a. having or covered with or accompanied by blood; r. extremely
funny 'fʌni POS: a	a. 好笑的, 有趣的, 滑稽的; n. 滑稽人物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. experiencing odd bodily sensations
shock ʃɒk POS: n	n. 震动, 冲突, 震惊, 冲击, 突击, 禾束堆, 休克, 长毛狗; vt. 使震动, 使休克, 使受电击, 震惊得; vi. 震动, 吓... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the violent interaction of individuals or groups entering into combat; n. (pathology) bodily collapse or ne...
amazing ə'meɪzɪŋ POS: a	a. 令人惊异的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. surprising greatly; s. inspiring awe or admiration or wonder
precisely pri'saɪsli POS: adv	adv. 精确地, 明确地, 刻板地, 拘泥地, 正好, 恰恰, 对, 正是如此, 确实如此, 不错 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. indicating exactness or preciseness; r. in a precise manner; r. just as it should be
exciting ik'saɪtɪŋ POS: a	a. 令人兴奋的, 刺激的; [电] 激磁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. creating or arousing excitement; s. stimulating interest and discussion
enthusiasm in'θju:zɪəzəm POS: n	n. 巨大的热情, 热心 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of excitement; n. a lively interest
controversial ,kɒntrə've:ʃəl POS: a	a. 争论的, 论争的, 被议论的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by or capable of arousing controversy
gaze geɪz POS: n	n. 注视, 凝视; vi. 注视, 凝视 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a long fixed look; v. look at with fixed eyes
sheer ʃiə POS: a	a. 绝对的, 全然的, 纯粹的, 透明的, 峻峭的; vi. 偏转, 偏航; vt. 使急转向, 使偏航; adv. 完全, 全然, 峻峭; n... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to sheer; r. straight up or down without a break; r. directly
legislative 'ledʒɪslətɪv POS: n	n. 立法机构; a. 立法的, 有立法权的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to a legislature or composed of members of a legislature; a. of or relating to or created by legis...
purple 'pɜ:pəl POS: n	n. 紫色, 帝位; a. 紫色的, 帝王的, 华而不实的; v. (使)成紫色 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a purple color or pigment; n. of imperial status; v. become purple; v. color purple
innovative 'ɪnə'veɪtɪv POS: a	a. 革新的, 创新的, 富有革新精神的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. being or producing something like nothing done or experienced or created before
enthusiastic in.θju:zɪ'æstɪk POS: a	a. 狂热的, 热心的, 热烈的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or showing great excitement and interest
weaken 'wi:kən POS: vt	vt. 削弱, 减弱, 使虚弱; vi. 变弱, 变软弱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. lessen the strength of; v. become weaker
colorful 'kɒləfəl POS: a	a. 华美的, 富有色彩的, 有趣的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having striking color; a. striking in variety and interest
brutal 'bru:təl POS: a	a. 残忍的, 野蛮的, 不讲理的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. harsh; s. disagreeably direct and precise
mist mɪst POS: n	n. 雾, 迷蒙, 朦胧不清; vt. 使模糊, 使蒙上雾; vi. 变模糊, 下雾 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a thin fog with condensation near the ground; v. become covered with mist; v. spray finely or cover with mist
soften 'sɒftn POS: v	v. (使)变柔软, (使)变柔和 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make (images or sounds) soft or softer; v. make soft or softer; v. become soft or softer
challenging 'tʃælɪndʒɪŋ POS: a	a. 挑战的, 引起争论的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. stimulating interest or thought; s. disturbingly provocative
delicious di'liʃəs POS: a	a. 美味的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. variety of sweet eating apples
terrify 'terɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 使恐惧, 恐吓 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. fill with terror; frighten greatly

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
fascinate 'fæsineɪt POS: vt	vt. 令人入神, 使着迷; vi. 入迷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. to render motionless, as with a fixed stare or by arousing terror or awe
awesome 'əʊsəm POS: a	a. 引起敬畏的, 可怕的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s inspiring awe or admiration or wonder
muddy 'mʌdi POS: a	a. 泥泞的, 浑浊的, 模糊的; vt. 使污浊, 使沾上泥土 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. dirty with mud; v. cause to become muddy; v. make turbid
disgusting dis'gʌstɪŋ POS: a	a. 令人厌恶的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. highly offensive; arousing aversion or disgust
fascination ,fæsi'neiʃən POS: n	n. 令人着迷的事物, 入迷, 魅力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being intensely interested (as by awe or terror); n. the capacity to attract intense interest
deceive di'si:v POS: v	v. 欺骗, 行骗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be false to; be dishonest with; v. cause someone to believe an untruth
awe ɔ: POS: n	n. 敬畏; vt. 使敬畏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an overwhelming feeling of wonder or admiration; v. inspire awe in
necessitate ni'sesiteit POS: vt	vt. 迫使, 使成为必需, 需要 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. require as useful, just, or proper; v. cause to be a concomitant
fasten 'fɑ:sən POS: vt	vt. 拴紧, 使固定, 系, 集中于, 强加于; vi. 扣紧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to be firmly attached; v. become fixed or fastened; v. attach to
sharpen 'ʃɑ:pən POS: vt	vt. 使尖锐, 使敏捷, 加重, 削尖; vi. 尖锐化, 变锋利 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make sharp or sharper; v. make crisp or more crisp and precise; v. become sharp or sharper; v. make (images) o...
bypass 'baɪpɑ:s POS: n	n. 旁路; vt. 省略, 绕过, 忽视, 回避 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a surgically created shunt (usually around a damaged part); v. avoid something unpleasant or laborious
creamy 'kri:mi POS: a	a. 含油脂的, 乳脂状的, 奶油色的; [建] 含乳油的, 似乳油的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. of the color of cream; s. thick like cream
annoy ə'noi POS: vt	vt. 使恼怒, 骚扰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause annoyance in; disturb, especially by minor irritations
adaptive ə'dæptɪv POS: a	a. 适应的, 能适应的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having a capacity for adaptation
darken 'dɑ:kən POS: vt	vt. 弄暗, 使模糊; vi. 暗下来, 颜色变深 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become dark or darker; v. tarnish or stain; v. make dark or darker
overthrow ,əuve'θrəu POS: n	n. 推翻, 瓦解, 倾覆; vt. 打倒, 推翻, 倾覆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the termination of a ruler or institution (especially by force); v. cause the downfall of; of rulers
horrify 'horɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 使恐惧, 使震惊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v fill with apprehension or alarm; cause to be unpleasantly surprised
hazy 'heɪzi POS: a	a. 朦胧的, 模糊的, 烟雾弥漫的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s filled or abounding with fog or mist; s indistinct or hazy in outline
urbanization ,ə:bənaɪ'zeɪʃən POS: n	n. 都市化; [医] 都市化, 人口城市集中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the condition of being urbanized; n. the social process whereby cities grow and societies become more urban
potentiality pəu.tenʃi'æliɪti POS: n	n. 潜在性, 可能性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the inherent capacity for coming into being; n an aptitude that may be developed
cigaret ,si'ʌ'ret,'si- POS: n	n. 纸烟, 卷烟, 香烟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n finely ground tobacco wrapped in paper; for smoking